

coming together. India is moving from playing games to creating games for the world.

What role does the IGPDA play?

Vishal: For the first time, the industry has one voice. Earlier, everyone worked alone. That slowed progress. The association brings people together, speaks clearly to the government, and helps studios grow faster. It creates shared systems, protects creators, and opens doors to global partners. Simply put, it helps Indian gaming move forward together, not in silos.

What do Indian studios really need to create global hit games?

Vishal: Exposure and scale. Talent and money matter, but nothing teaches faster than working at global scale. When international gaming companies build serious teams in India, Indian creators learn faster, earn better, and build confidence. This approach has worked in other industries. It can work for gaming too, while Indian studios build their own original games alongside.

How important is Indian culture in games meant for the global market?

Vishal: It is our biggest strength, if done honestly. Culture is not decoration. It is emotion. Courage, family, sacrifice, ambition. These are universal feelings.

When Indian stories are told with care and strong gameplay, they feel fresh to global players. Our history, cities, and modern lives offer stories the world has not played before. That is where India stands out.

Most gaming money still goes to foreign games. How do we change that?

Vishal: By earning trust. Indian players support Indian games when the quality is high. Success must be reinvested into better games, better events, and stronger communities. Games should feel local, celebrate

WHAT IS IGPDA?

The Indian Game Publishers and Developers Association (IGPDA) is a new industry body formed in August 2025 to give India's burgeoning game creation ecosystem its first truly unified voice. Brought together by nine of the country's leading studios and publishers – including Nazara Technologies, Gametion, nCore Games, Reliance Games, SuperGaming, Tara Gaming, underDOGS Studio, Aeos Games, and Dot9 Games – IGPDA was created to champion Made-in-India intellectual property and strengthen the nation's gaming ambitions on the global stage.

Structured to represent both developers and publishers, the association's mission spans policy advocacy, skills development, global partner engagement, and ecosystem building – all aimed at helping Indian creators scale up to compete internationally. With the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025 providing a clearer regulatory framework for video games in India, IGPDA has seized the moment to push for supportive policies, investment attraction, and industry standards that match global expectations.

Among its early initiatives are proposed partnerships with state governments (notably Maharashtra) to develop gaming hubs, combined industry events, and collaborative talent-building programs.

festivals, support esports careers, and create real opportunities. When players feel pride, they stay.

Which areas of gaming excite you most for India's future?

Vishal: Mobile games that can become spectator sports. Deep mobile games that people play for years. Games inspired by Indian life, farming, families, cricket, and cities. And new technologies like AR and VR for learning and training.

What more should the government do?

Vishal: Give clarity and confidence. Games should be clearly separated from gambling. Development should be supported with incentives, just like films and animation. Taxes and rules should be simple and predictable. Creators need room to experiment and take risks.

Do PC, console have a future in India?

Vishal: Yes, as a premium space. As incomes rise, more players will want deeper, richer experiences. Consoles

and PCs help Indian developers learn global quality standards. They may not be mass-market, but they are very important.

Long-term vision for Indian gaming?

Vishal: I want India to be known worldwide for great games with heart and originality. Not just exporting games, but creating new styles of play. I want Indian games to turn into movies, shows, and global franchises. And I want a child from any small town to believe this is a real career and actually make it happen in India.

What would you tell young people and their parents about gaming as a career?

Vishal: To young people, this is a serious profession. It needs discipline, skill, and effort. Learn to build, not just play. To parents, gaming is no longer a distraction. It is a real industry with real careers. Support the passion, guide the learning, and stay involved. India has missed many digital revolutions. Gaming is one we should lead. 